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Teaching Statement

Introduction

I enjoy teaching. I particularly enjoy helping students make sense of work they find difficult. Much of this progress happens through one-on-one or small group coaching. I see answering questions and revisiting explanations as an essential part of teaching. I want students to question assumptions, explain their reasoning, and apply economics to real-life situations.

At Binghamton University, I taught Statistical Methods in Summer 2025. I designed the syllabus, lectures, problem sets, data exercises, and assessments around the course's learning objectives. My teaching assistantships span introductory and intermediate microeconomics, macroeconomics, econometrics, and data analytics. In Introduction to Econometrics, I also lead R instruction.

Teaching Philosophy

My teaching philosophy centers on rigorous reasoning, active practice, and accessible support. I want students to become independent thinkers who can examine unfamiliar problems. They should understand why a method fits a question and where its assumptions limit the conclusions. I connect intuition, formal reasoning, and applications to develop these abilities.

Students can follow a worked solution without being able to reproduce its reasoning. In Introduction to Econometrics, students struggled to derive ordinary least squares estimators and prove unbiasedness and consistency. I returned to the foundations. I derived the estimators through least squares and the method of moments. I explained the assumptions behind each proof. Students explained the reasoning back to me and derived the estimators in class. Their responses helped me judge when they were ready for applications and hypothesis testing. Extra classes and additional office hours provided further support.

In microeconomics, I ask students to predict the effects of a tax. They work through the graph and explain the result in words. In R instruction, I connect data preparation, estimation, and interpretation through practical examples and reproducible scripts. I explain the econometric ideas alongside the code.

Participation helps reveal difficulties that might otherwise remain hidden. I invite questions and call on students at random to explain their reasoning. Incorrect answers are a natural part of learning. We identify the mistaken step and work toward the correct answer. I respond respectfully while making the correction clear. I recognize that students differ in how quickly they organize their thoughts.

Students also differ in their mathematical and programming preparation. I assigned weekly homework and additional practice questions. Lecture videos, slides, and notes let students revisit difficult steps at their own pace. An online platform supported peer discussion before students brought unresolved questions to me. Flexible office hours offered individual support. These resources provide several ways to work toward the same learning objectives.

Assessment and Feedback

Students' derivations and explanations help me decide what to revisit before moving to applications. In future courses, I would ask for short written explanations alongside calculations. I would assess method choice, reasoning, and interpretation as well as the numerical answer. Annotated solutions would explain common mistakes and the assumptions behind each step. I would use recurring errors to guide classroom review. A follow-up problem would give students a chance to apply the correction to a new question. My goal is for feedback to guide their next attempt.

Undergraduate Mentoring

I would extend the individual guidance I value to undergraduate research. Mentoring would begin with a student's interests, preparation, and goals. We would turn a broad topic into a manageable question, identify feasible data, and agree on milestones. Regular meetings would review progress and reasoning. I would help students document their work, distinguish descriptive patterns from causal claims, and revise their writing. As their confidence grows, I would give them more responsibility for choosing the next step.

My industry experience reinforces the importance of making analysis useful to others. At First Bank of Nigeria, I developed customer-dormancy and transaction-channel models to support retention and service decisions. This experience informs my emphasis on clear explanations and documentation that another person can follow.

I would also expose students to important empirical papers through replication. I would select papers suited to their interests, preparation, and learning goals. Using public data and code, students could reproduce a central table or figure. They would explain the research question, method, assumptions, and limitations. They could then examine an alternative specification and discuss whether the conclusions change. This process would deepen their understanding of empirical research and help them develop their own questions.

Evidence

Preparation, explanation, and support. Seven of nine students responded to my Summer 2025 Statistical Methods evaluation. On a five-point scale, preparation averaged 4.43 and explanations of complex material averaged 4.17. Encouraging analytical thinking and availability outside class both averaged 4.14. I consider these ratings alongside students' explanations and in-class work when reflecting on my teaching.

Clear explanations. In my econometrics TA evaluation, a student described how my support made difficult material more manageable: "The course was interesting and even though challenging at times it was manageable with the TA's help and explanations."

Class participation. Another student wrote: "So with the random calling it does help us go over things that we need help with and are too nervous to talk about." This feedback suggests that structured participation can reveal unresolved difficulties. Peer discussion and individual support complement classroom participation, recognizing differences in students' comfort with speaking in class.

Conclusion

I am prepared to teach principles and intermediate microeconomics and macroeconomics, statistics for economists, and introductory and intermediate econometrics. My goal is to pair rigorous standards with support that helps students meet them. Through explanation, practice, feedback, and mentoring, I want students to develop independent reasoning. They should leave my courses better able to assess economic arguments and communicate their conclusions clearly.